The Harbor Survey

The harbor survey began in the spring, when the ice had cleared from the inner channel and the pilots could take the launch out at first light. Each morning the crew measured the depth at forty marked stations, wrote the readings in a bound log, and compared them with the charts drawn twenty years before.

By the middle of summer the pattern was plain. The channel had shifted toward the eastern breakwater, and the shoal off the old ferry landing had grown by almost a meter. The pilots had known this for years from the feel of the boats, but the survey gave them numbers they could show the port council.

The council voted in the autumn to dredge the eastern approach and to move two of the channel buoys. The survey crew stayed on through the winter to check the work, and their final log, bound in green cloth, is kept in the harbor office today.

Quarterly Rainfall by Station

Station	Winter	Spring	Summer	Autumn
North Ridge	212 mm	148 mm	64 mm	190 mm
Mill Creek	187 mm	131 mm	58 mm	176 mm
Lower Valley	143 mm	102 mm	41 mm	129 mm
Harbor Point	236 mm	159 mm	77 mm	214 mm
Cedar Flats	98 mm	86 mm	35 mm	91 mm
East Summit	254 mm	171 mm	82 mm	233 mm

Readings are totals for each quarter, rounded to the nearest millimeter.

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Library Card Application

Full name: Margaret Ellen Doyle

Street address: 41 Orchard Lane

City: Fairhaven

Postal code: 04821

Telephone: 555 0142

Date of birth: 12 March 1987

Card type: Adult

Signed by the applicant on 3 June 2026.

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Seasonal Water Levels

The reservoir rises through the wet months and falls through the dry ones. The chart below shows the average level at the end of each season over the last ten years.

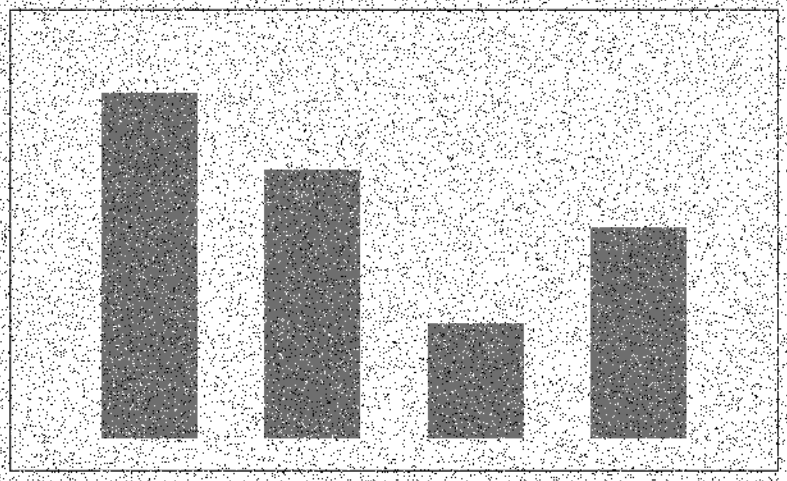


Figure 1: Average reservoir level at the end of winter, spring, summer, and autumn.

The lowest level comes at the end of summer, when demand is highest and the inflow is smallest.

Notes on Garden Soil

Good garden soil holds water without staying wet. A handful squeezed in the palm should keep its shape for a moment and then crumble when pressed with a thumb.

Clay soil drains slowly and warms late in the spring. Working in leaf mold and coarse sand over several seasons opens it up and lets roots reach deeper.

Sandy soil drains quickly and loses its nutrients in heavy rain. Compost added each autumn gives it body and feeds the worms that keep it loose.

Most vegetables grow best in soil that is slightly acid. A simple test kit from the hardware store shows the level in a few minutes.

Lime raises the level slowly and should go on in the autumn, so the winter rain can carry it down. Sulfur lowers it, but more slowly still.

Whatever the soil, a layer of mulch keeps it cool in summer, holds moisture through dry weeks, and smothers most of the weeds before they start.

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